

MANDAR DEODHAR

Sabyasachi Mukherjee

There is no such thing as understatement in the Sabyasachi Mukherjee playbook. Opulence is the designer's hallmark and a 'Sabyasachi Bride' an aspiration for royalty of different stripes—Bollywood or business. A master storyteller, he is known for his revivalist approach towards Indian fashion as well as his arresting campaigns celebrating body positivity. The Kolkata-based couturier does not believe in half-measures, his resplendent regal stores a testimony to that fact. New York opened its doors to his first international store; his jewellery line and home decor range had already found a niche in the city's luxury department store Bergdorf Goodman. Mukherjee has also become the first Indian designer to collaborate with high street brand H&M, which has previously worked with Versace, Lanvin, Roberto Cavalli, among others. Why, he's even lending colour and his name to wallpapers and paints by Asian Paints.

Manish Malhotra

He was dressing Bollywood celebs long before it became de rigueur to have a stylist put your look together. Manish Malhotra had dressed Karisma Kapoor and Madhuri Dixit in *Dil To Pagal Hai* [1997], Kajol and Rani Mukherjee in *Kuch Kuch Hota Hai* [1998] and Kareena Kapoor Khan in *Kabhi Khushi Kabhie Gham...* [2001]. But it was what he did for Urmila Matondkar in *Rangeela* [1995]—in crop tops and high-waisted jeans, skirts with thigh-high slits, shorts with belts—that burnished his go-to designer credentials. In 2005 came his eponymous label for bridal wear and men's formals. More recently, fashion circles welcomed Manish Malhotra Beauty, the first-ever haute couture make-up line, which the serial entrepreneur has launched with beauty conglomerate MyGlamm. Behind all the glamour is hard work—Malhotra has worked extensively to revive *chikankari* and Kashmiri embroidery. He is also closely associated with the Mijwan Welfare Society, which works for the empowerment of women—with whom he does a show every year.



MILIND SHELTE